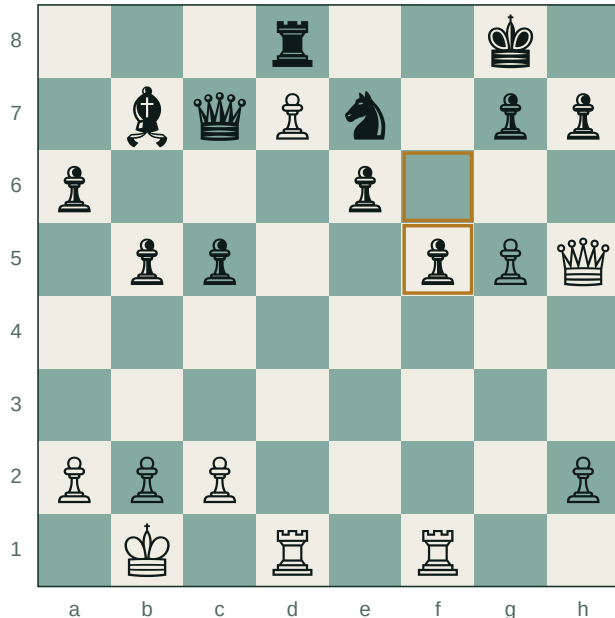


# Kingside attacks: White, move 29

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 28...f5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**29. Qe8+ Rxe8 30. dxe8=Q#**

**29.Qe8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e8 it attacks king on g8, rook on d8 and knight on e7. Recorded reply: **29...Rxe8**.

**30.dxe8=Q#** Mate: queen on e8 gives check; Black has no legal reply. The pawn becomes a queen.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on e8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on e7 and queen on c7. Check for tactical protection.